

WHAT	WAS	NOW	HOW MANY	WHERE FROM	GOT
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Jumper / cardigan					☐
Shirts / polos					☐
Trousers / skirt					☐
Dress					☐
PE top					☐
PE shorts / joggers					☐
Socks / tights					☐
Coat					☐
School shoes					☐
PE trainers					☐
Wellingtons					☐
Book bag / rucksack					☐
Water bottle					☐
Lunchbox					☐
Swimming kit					☐

WHAT	HOW	GOT	NAMED
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[illegible]

The bag comes home. The jumper does not. Everything that can be taken off during a school day needs a name on the item itself — jumper, coat, PE kit, water bottle, lunchbox, and **both shoes**, inside. It is an hour in August and it is the difference between losing four jumpers a year and losing none.

- ☐ Iron-on tapes — survive the wash, slow to do
- ☐ Stick-on labels — for bottles, boxes and pencil cases
- ☐ A laundry marker on the care label — free, and enough
- ☐ Sew-on, if the school insists

Ordered on	How many
1	1
2	2
3	3
4	4
5	5
6	6
7	7
8	8
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10	10
11	11
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93	93
94	94
95	95
96	96
97	97
98	98
99	99
100	100

- ☐ Every jumper and cardigan
- ☐ The coat, inside the collar
- ☐ Both shoes, and both trainers
- ☐ Water bottle and lunchbox
- ☐ PE bag and everything in it

What the year actually costs.

Date

4/9

LINE BY LINE Guess first, then write what it really was

WHAT	RECKONED	REALLY	PAID
Uniform			☐
School shoes			☐
PE kit and trainers			☐
Coat			☐
Bag and lunchbox			☐
Stationery			☐
Books			☐
School dinners / snacks			☐
Clubs and lessons			☐
Trips			☐
Photographs			☐
Charity and dressing-up days			☐

It is never the uniform, it is the twelfth thing

Most people budget for the uniform and the shoes and stop there. The rest of the list above — trips, clubs, photographs, the dressing-up day in October — arrives in letters, one at a time, and is never added up. Total it in August and the letters stop being a surprise.

PAID MONTHLY, NOT ONCE Dinners, clubs, the milk

WHAT	PER MONTH	SET UP
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

HELP THAT EXISTS AND IS NOT ADVERTISED Ask the...

- ☐ A uniform grant or voucher, if there is one
- ☐ Free or reduced school meals
- ☐ Help with trips and residentials
- ☐ Paying for a big trip in instalments

WHAT WE ARE NOT BUYING THIS YEAR

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
NEEDS _____	NEEDS _____	NEEDS _____	NEEDS _____	NEEDS _____
☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____
☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____
☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____
☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____
☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____
AFTER SCHOOL _____	AFTER SCHOOL _____	AFTER SCHOOL _____	AFTER SCHOOL _____	AFTER SCHOOL _____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
COLLECTED BY _____	COLLECTED BY _____	COLLECTED BY _____	COLLECTED BY _____	COLLECTED BY _____

PE kit on Tuesday, library book on Thursday, recorder on Friday, forest school wellingtons on the week you forget. None of it is hard to remember and all of it is impossible to remember at half past eight. This page lives by the front door, not in a folder.

Four slots, every day

Monday

Tuesday

Wednesday

Thursday

Friday

Most schools ban nuts outright, and many also rule on sweets, chocolate, fizzy drinks and glass. Write the actual rule here rather than remembering a version of it — and if your child has an allergy, the office needs it in writing and the class teacher needs to have read it, which are two different things.

THIS SCHOOL'S RULES _____

WHO	WHAT	OFFICE	CLASS
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KIT THAT MAKES IT QUICKER

- ☐ A box they can open themselves, tested at home
- ☐ A bottle that does not leak in a bag
- ☐ Something prepared on Sunday for all five days
- ☐ A spare box, for the day one is left at school

Every difficult school morning is really an evening that did not happen. This page is meant to be printed once and used every night until nobody needs to read it — which takes about three weeks. Tick it for the first fortnight, then stop; by then it is a habit and the page has done its job.

- ☐ Bag emptied — letters, lunchbox, anything wet
- ☐ Tomorrow checked against the week on page 5
- ☐ Uniform out, all of it, including socks
- ☐ Shoes by the door, together
- ☐ Lunch made, or made as far as it will keep
- ☐ Bottle washed and filled
- ☐ Reading book and homework signed and in the bag
- ☐ Bag by the door, zipped

Wake, curtains, lights on

Breakfast

Dressed

Teeth and hair

Shoes and coat

Out of the door

Wakes at So, asleep by

Which means upstairs at

☐ A clock they can read, in their room

- One instruction at a time, not a list

☐ Breakfast they can start without help

☐ Ten minutes earlier, rather than louder

☐ The same order every morning, so it stops needing to be said

Date **8/9**

THE MORNING ITSELF

WHAT TO ASK AT PICK-UP — “How was school?” gets you nothing

HOW IT WENT

KEEP THIS WEEK LIGHT

WORTH MENTIONING TO THE TEACHER

9/9

Office

Absence line, and by what time

Class teacher

Teaching assistant

Head of year

Before / after-school club

School email or app

School nurse or first aid

In writing, to the ...

WHO

NUMBER

TOLD

☐☐☐☐

1

WHO, AND WHOSE PARENT

NUMBER

HAVE
IT

☐☐☐☐☐

SEPTEMBER ADMIN, DONE ONCE

☐ Every form signed and sent back

☐ Medical and allergy details updated

☐ The payment app set up before you need it

☐ Emergency contacts checked, not assumed

☐ Term dates in your own calendar, all of them

Written now, worth ten next ...